

Gardens by the Bay

A stunning horticultural park that combines natural beauty with innovative green technology and architecture



SE. Asia

Situated on 10 million square ft (1 million square m) of reclaimed land in the Central Region of Singapore, Gardens by the Bay is an award-winning horticultural park. It was created following an international design competition held in 2006 as part of Singapore's plans to transform its "Garden City" into a "City in a Garden" and build an internationally recognizable landmark.

Going green

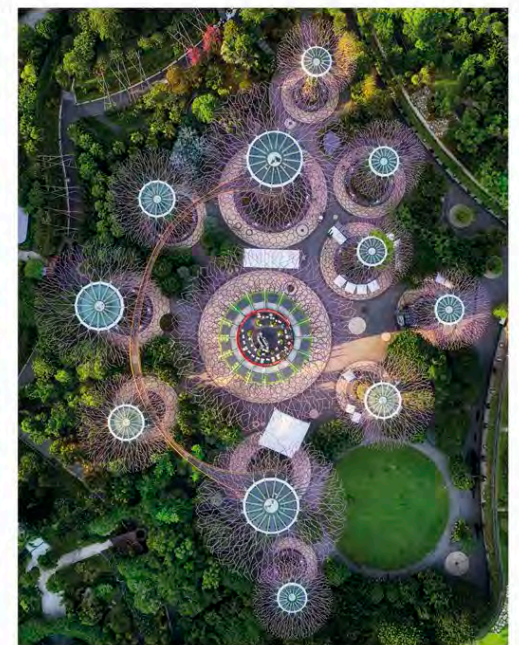
The park is divided into three gardens: Bay South, Bay East, and Bay Central. Opened in 2012, Bay South is the largest and most developed garden; it spans 6 million square ft (540,000 square m), its layout inspired by Singapore's national flower, the "Miss Joaquim" orchid. Although it contains several distinct areas, the garden is defined by 18 massive "supertrees" and vast, climate-controlled biomes. The supertrees are 82–164 ft (25–50 m) high, and several are connected by a walkway that is 420 ft (128 m) long. Not only are the trees home to 162,900 plants and over 200

species, but they are also a valuable part of the development's sustainable energy-management system. Some are fitted with solar panels, and some harvest rainwater that both generates energy through a turbine and is used in the greenhouse cooling systems or for irrigation. Others serve as air intake and exhaust towers for the air handling systems. And, of course, they also provide shade for the park's visitors.

Cooled conservatories

Bay South's two climate-controlled biomes cover a combined area of 248,000 square ft (23,000 square m). The Flower Dome is the world's largest columnless glasshouse, while the Cloud Forest has its own 138-ft- (42-m-) high mountain, clad in tropical plants, encircled by a walkway, and housing the world's largest indoor waterfall. Gardens by the Bay are still under development, but they are already one of Singapore's most popular attractions.

Four themed "Heritage Gardens" reflect Singapore's various cultural groups—Indian, Chinese, Malay, and Colonial



△ GLOWING ARBORETUM

Illuminated by neon lights, the supertrees show off their own beauty, as well as that of the ferns, vines, orchids, and bromeliads that climb their sides.

◁ HARDWORKING TREES

Form and function combine in the elegant branches of the supertrees, which also help mask vents and rain-collection systems hidden in the treetops.